UPFRONT PROTEIN BARS

360° Marketing Strategy

Objective

To design a data-driven 360° marketing strategy for Upfront protein bars, focusing on students and active young consumers, by integrating digital and physical channels to improve brand visibility, engagement, and conversion.

Target Group

- Students & young active consumer (18 - 30)
- Need energy & focus
- Health - conscious
- Active lifestyle

This target group shows a growing demand for protein-rich, on-the-go products, driven by increasing health awareness, fitness trends, and the need for convenient nutrition in daily routines.

USP's & UBR'S

USP's

- Accessible Lifestyle Nutrition
- Balanced Price–Quality Positioning
- Broad Lifestyle Appeal
- Transparent ingredients clean-label

UBR's

- "Fits daily routine easily"
- "Good nutritional value for its price"
- "Boosts energy and focus daily"
- "Feels like a safe, honest choice"





Benchmark

Brand	Price per bar	Protein	Flavours	Distribution	Brand Positioning	Strength	Weakness
Upfront Protein Bar	~€2.29	20g	4	Albert Heijn, online	Lifestyle protein snack	Simple positioning	Limited flavour variety
Barebells	~€2.49	20g	10+	Supermarkets, gyms	Fitness lifestyle	Strong taste marketing	Highly competitive segment
Fulfil	~€2.39	20g	8	Supermarkets	Protein + vitamins	Added nutritional value	Less strong brand personality
Grenade Carb Killa	~€2.69	20g	12+	Gyms, online	Hardcore fitness nutrition	Strong fitness identity	Higher price
AH High Protein Bar	~€1.59	15g	3	Albert Heijn	Budget protein snack	Low price	Lower protein & weaker branding





Customer Journey & Cross - Media Strategy

360° approach combining online & offline channels



Targets & KPIs

Awareness

Target:
Increase brand awareness among students by +30% within 3 months.

KPIs:

- TikTok views: ≥ 100,000 views per campaign
- Reach: +30% increase
- Impressions: ≥ 150,000

Engagement

Target:
Increase engagement and interaction by +20%

KPIs:

- Engagement rate: ≥ 8%
- Likes & shares: +20% growth
- Followers: +15% increase

Conversion

Target:
Increase sales in target locations by +15%

KPIs:

- Conversion rate: 5–8%
- Sales volume: +15% increase
- Trial purchases (sampling): ≥ 500 units/month

Marketing / Social Media Campaign

Fuel Your Focus

Objective

Increase awareness and engagement among students and active young consumers, and drive product trial and sales.

Channels

- TikTok (main awareness channel)
- Instagram (engagement & community)
- On-campus & gym activations (conversion)

Concept

Students and gym users share short videos showing how Upfront helps them stay focused, energized, and productive during study or workouts.

Example content:
"Study with me + Upfront bar"
"Gym routine + quick energy snack"
"Before vs after energy boost"

Execution

- Collaborate with micro-influencers (students & fitness creators)
- Encourage user-generated content (UGC)
- Use hashtag: #FuelYourFocus



Conclusion

The 360° marketing strategy shows that combining social media with physical presence in gyms and universities can effectively increase brand awareness, engagement, and sales among students and active young consumers.



Advice

Upfront should focus on strengthening its presence in daily consumer environments while continuously using social media to build engagement and brand identity. Expanding distribution in universities and gyms will further increase accessibility and purchase opportunities.